public limelight.

The New Constitution for India which brought about the separation of Burma from India had been passed by the British Parliament in 1935. This gave the Indian people a certain measure of autonomy in the Provinces. Provincial elections under the new Constitution were to be held in the winter of 1936-37. The Parliamentary Wing of the Congress (which was now synonymous with the Gandhian Wing) began to prepare for these elections and also for the acceptance of ministerial office, thereafter, in the provinces. The Congress Socialist Party had originally opposed participation in these elections—an attitude which was reminiscent of the attitude of the orthodox Gandhiite "no-change party" in 1922-23. Later on, the C. S. Party modified its attitude and supported the idea of contesting the elections, but strongly opposed the idea of accepting ministerial office. The C. S. P. did not have a clear revolutionary perspective and this was probably due to the fact that in the ranks of that Party, there were disillusioned ex-Gandhiites who were, however, still under the influence of Gandhian concepts—while there were others in the Party who were under the influence of Nehru's sentimental politics.

In 1936-37, the C. S. Party sponsored an "Anti-Ministry" movement with the objective of opposing the acceptance of ministerial office by Congressmen. Among those who supported this move, but were not members of the C.S.P., were Sardar Sardul Singh Cavesheer of Punjab[1], Rafi Ahmed Kidwai[2], of the United Provinces, Mrs. V. L. Pandit[3] and Sarat Chandra Bose[4] (brother of the writer). Pandit Nehru gave his moral support to the movement.

In spite of all the checks and safeguards provided in the New Constitution for preventing the Nationalists from getting a majority, the Congress Party emerged from the provincial parliamentary elections with a practical majority in seven out of eleven provinces in British India. At that time, the anti-ministry movement was going strong—but the Parliamentarian (or Gandhian) leaders of the Congress handled the situation with such consummate skill,

[1] Cavesheer later became the Vice-President of the All-India Forward Bloc.

[2] Kidwai later became the Home Minister of the Congress Cabinet in U P.

[3] Mrs. Pandit also became a Minister in U. P.

[4] Bose became later the leader of the Congress Party in the Benga Legislature.